THE LAST SIGNAL

A Blackwood Mystery — Fictional Series Reference Guide

SEASON ONE • 10 EPISODES • ORIGINAL FICTION

A remote radio station. A town that has edited its own history. And a transmission that should not exist.

Prepared as a self-contained knowledge document for testing retrieval-augmented generation (RAG). All people, places, organizations, events and dates in this guide are fictional.

How to use this guide

This guide is the authoritative reference for the fictional first season of The Last Signal. Treat the facts stated here as the series canon. If a question asks for information that is not stated in this guide, the correct response is that the guide does not provide that information.

The season contains facts that recur across episodes. Some questions require combining details from more than one episode. Names, dates, room numbers, object descriptions and relationships are deliberately specific so that retrieval quality can be tested.

Series premise

Blackwood is a small mountain town in the fictional country of Norvale. In 1998, a storm destroyed the town's old emergency radio station, Relay House. The official report said the station was empty when the storm hit. Twenty-eight years later, audio archivist Mara Venn discovers a recording that appears to have been transmitted from Relay House three days after it was supposedly abandoned.

Mara returns to Blackwood with a portable recorder and begins investigating. She is joined by local journalist Ivo Chen. Their search reveals that Relay House was part of a secret warning network called Project Lantern. The network was designed to send evacuation instructions during landslides, but someone altered its records to conceal a failed evacuation drill.

The central mystery is not simply who sent the signal. It is why the town agreed to forget the people who tried to warn it.

Blackwood: places and landmarks

Relay House: The decommissioned radio station on North Ridge. Its transmitter room is on the ground floor; the archive vault is below ground, behind a blue steel door.

Morrow Square: The town's central plaza. The clock tower stopped at 9:17 p.m. during the storm of 1998.

Cedar Clinic: A small medical clinic on Bell Street. Dr. Sera Holt kept handwritten patient-transfer logs in a locked cabinet.

North Ridge Tunnel: A service tunnel beneath the ridge. Its eastern entrance is concealed behind a disused water tank.

The Glass Hotel: A hotel overlooking Morrow Square. Room 214 was used for a private meeting on 12 October 1998.

Blackwood Municipal Archive: A records building beside the old railway platform. The basement contains boxes transferred from Relay House in 2001.

Pine Reservoir: A reservoir west of town. The emergency siren can be heard clearly from its southern bank.

Old Quarry Road: A narrow road that was closed after a landslide in 1998. A maintenance gate is marked with the number 06.

Main characters

Mara Venn: Age 34; audio archivist; born in Blackwood and left at age 12. Carries a silver field recorder inherited from her grandfather Elias.

Ivo Chen: Age 31; reporter for the Blackwood Ledger. His mother, Lian Chen, was a volunteer radio operator during the 1998 storm.

Dr. Sera Holt: Age 59; retired physician at Cedar Clinic. She treated injured residents after the storm and preserved the clinic's transfer logs.

Jonas Rook: Age 67; former chief engineer at Relay House. He insists the transmitter was switched off before the storm.

Nadia Vale: Age 42; current mayor of Blackwood. Her father, Tomas Vale, chaired the town emergency committee in 1998.

Elias Venn: Would have been 81; Mara's grandfather and a radio technician. He disappeared on 15 October 1998 and was officially listed as having left town.

Lian Chen: Age 58; Ivo's mother and former volunteer radio operator. She remembers receiving a warning at 8:42 p.m. on the night of the storm.

Tomas Vale: Deceased; former chair of the emergency committee. He signed the 1998 report declaring Relay House empty.

Rafi Dast: Age 29; mechanic who maintains the old water pumps. He finds a brass key near the North Ridge Tunnel.

Anika Sol: Age 46; municipal archivist. She catalogued the Relay House boxes after their transfer in 2001.

Felix Ward: Age 53; owner of the Glass Hotel. He denies knowing why Room 214 was reserved in October 1998.

Mina Orlov: Age 38; geologist who maps landslide risks. She discovers that the 1998 evacuation map omitted the eastern slope.

Pavel Neri: Age 61; former railway signalman. He recorded a train delay on the night of the storm.

June Armit: Age 72; retired school principal. She kept a class attendance book showing which children were moved before the storm.

Kellan Voss: Age 40; radio hobbyist. He identifies the signal's repeating four-note audio marker.

Important organizations and terms

Project Lantern: A confidential emergency-warning network created in 1996 to connect Relay House, Cedar Clinic and the municipal siren.

Lantern Code 4: A four-note marker used to authenticate genuine Project Lantern transmissions. The notes are G, C, E and D, in that order.

Blue Ledger: A handwritten logbook recording every Project Lantern transmission. It was kept in the archive vault at Relay House.

The 1998 storm: A severe storm that triggered a landslide on 14 October 1998. The clock tower stopped at 9:17 p.m.

Station Blackout: The official name given to the loss of radio contact with Relay House. The report says it began at 9:05 p.m.

Transfer 11: The municipal archive transfer entry dated 3 March 2001. It lists eleven boxes from Relay House, although only ten were delivered.

Season One episode guide

Episode 1: The Empty Frequency

Story date: 4 May 2026

The opening episode begins when Mara Venn digitizes a damaged cassette labelled 'North Ridge / 17 October 1998'. At 02:13 on the tape, a calm voice says: 'Lantern is still lit. Do not use the eastern road.' Mara recognizes the voice as her grandfather Elias, although her family believed he had left Blackwood before the recording was made.

Key scenes

• At the Blackwood Municipal Archive, Anika Sol confirms that the cassette was not part of the official Relay House collection.

• Ivo Chen publishes a short article about the recording. The article brings an anonymous envelope to the Ledger office.

• The envelope contains a photograph of Relay House taken on 17 October 1998. A figure is visible in the transmitter-room window.

• Mara meets Jonas Rook, who says the station's power was disconnected on 14 October 1998.

Evidence and continuity details

• The cassette label gives the date as 17 October 1998, three days after the storm.

• The voice uses the phrase 'eastern road', a route that does not appear on the official evacuation map.

• The photograph has a handwritten time on the back: 06:40 a.m.

• Jonas says he personally removed the transmitter fuse, but cannot produce a maintenance record.

Episode outcome: Mara decides to return to Relay House. Ivo agrees to investigate who delivered the envelope.

Episode 2: The Blue Door

Story date: 6 May 2026

Mara and Ivo enter Relay House with help from Rafi Dast. Behind a rack of broken receivers, Mara finds a blue steel door leading to a sealed archive vault. The lock is old, but the keyway has fresh scratches. Rafi discovers a brass key inside the casing of a wall clock.

Key scenes

• The brass key opens the archive vault, but the door alarm has been disconnected.

• Inside, the team finds empty shelves, a water-damaged desk and a rectangular clean patch where a ledger once rested.

• Mara finds a strip of paper under the desk with the words 'Box 11 — not for transfer' written in blue ink.

• Ivo notices that the vault's ventilation grille opens into the North Ridge Tunnel.

Evidence and continuity details

• The vault is behind the blue steel door on the ground floor's lower level.

• The missing ledger is believed to be the Blue Ledger.

• The phrase 'Box 11 — not for transfer' connects the vault to Transfer 11 in the municipal archive.

• Rafi keeps the brass key after Mara photographs it.

Episode outcome: The group confirms that someone removed records from the vault after the station was officially closed.

Episode 3: Room 214

Story date: 9 May 2026

Ivo traces the anonymous envelope to the Glass Hotel. Felix Ward admits that Room 214 was reserved under the name 'E. Vale' on 12 October 1998, two days before the storm. The reservation was paid in cash, and the guest requested that no telephone calls be connected.

Key scenes

• Felix produces a faded registration card from a locked drawer.

• Mara notices that the signature on the card resembles the capital letters in the note found at Relay House.

• At the hotel, Ivo interviews June Armit, who says Tomas Vale held a private meeting there with Jonas Rook and an unknown woman.

• June remembers seeing a map tube carried out of Room 214 shortly before midnight.

Evidence and continuity details

• Room 214 was reserved on 12 October 1998 under the name E. Vale.

• The guest requested no telephone calls.

• June identifies Tomas Vale and Jonas Rook as attendees, but does not identify the unknown woman.

• The map tube was dark green and had a brass cap.

Episode outcome: Mara suspects the hotel meeting concerned the evacuation map, but the identity of the third attendee remains unknown.

Episode 4: Four Notes

Story date: 12 May 2026

Kellan Voss isolates a repeating sound buried beneath the voice on Mara's cassette. It is the four-note marker used by Project Lantern. Kellan identifies the notes as G, C, E and D. Lian Chen hears the recording and says she received the same marker at 8:42 p.m. on the night of the storm.

Key scenes

• Kellan compares the cassette with a surviving training tape from 1996.

• Lian says the warning she received instructed volunteers to prepare Cedar Clinic for twelve additional patients.

• Mina Sol overlays the official evacuation map with modern slope data and finds that the eastern slope was excluded from the 1998 map.

• Jonas admits that Project Lantern existed, but says it was only a test network.

Evidence and continuity details

• Lantern Code 4 is G, C, E, D, in that order.

• Lian received the marker at 8:42 p.m. on 14 October 1998.

• The message prepared Cedar Clinic for twelve additional patients.

• The official evacuation map omitted the eastern slope.

Episode outcome: The team establishes that a genuine Project Lantern transmission was sent before the reported Station Blackout.

Episode 5: The Missing Twelve

Story date: 15 May 2026

Dr. Sera Holt opens the clinic cabinet she has kept locked since retirement. Her transfer log records twelve patients arriving from the eastern slope between 9:30 p.m. and 10:10 p.m. on 14 October 1998. The official town report lists only seven storm injuries.

Key scenes

• Sera shows Mara the original clinic log, including the names of the twelve patients.

• June Armit's attendance book confirms that four children were collected from the eastern school before the main road closed.

• Ivo discovers that the official report was typed on 20 October 1998, six days after the storm.

• One patient entry is marked 'E.V. — observation only' and has no discharge signature.

Evidence and continuity details

• The clinic received twelve patients from the eastern slope between 9:30 p.m. and 10:10 p.m.

• The official report lists seven injuries, five fewer than the clinic log.

• The initials E.V. appear on a patient entry, but the guide does not establish the patient's full identity.

• The report was typed on 20 October 1998.

Episode outcome: The discrepancy proves that the official report omitted five people from the clinic's account, but the reason is still unclear.

Episode 6: The Eastern Road

Story date: 18 May 2026

Mina and Rafi survey the old eastern route. Behind the maintenance gate marked 06, they find a damaged emergency beacon and a weatherproof tube containing a map. The map shows a temporary footpath that connected the eastern slope to Cedar Clinic. Its margin carries Elias Venn's initials.

Key scenes

• The route is passable on foot but not by vehicle.

• Mina dates the map paper to the late 1990s based on its manufacturer watermark.

• Rafi repairs the emergency beacon and finds its last recorded activation time: 9:11 p.m. on 14 October 1998.

• At the southern bank of Pine Reservoir, Ivo finds a second beacon casing with no battery.

Evidence and continuity details

• The eastern footpath connected the eastern slope to Cedar Clinic.

• The maintenance gate is marked 06.

• The beacon at gate 06 was activated at 9:11 p.m. on 14 October 1998.

• The map bears Elias Venn's initials.

Episode outcome: The team finds evidence that the eastern route was used during the storm, despite being absent from the official map.

Episode 7: Transfer Eleven

Story date: 21 May 2026

Anika Sol reopens the 2001 archive-transfer register. Transfer 11 lists eleven boxes from Relay House, but the receiving clerk signed for only ten. A carbon copy of the receipt names the missing box as 'Lantern Operations — Original'. Anika says the signature belongs to Tomas Vale.

Key scenes

• The register gives the transfer date as 3 March 2001.

• The ten delivered boxes are still stored in the municipal archive basement.

• Mara finds a duplicate index card listing the Blue Ledger as item 11-B.

• Ivo discovers that the archive's basement inventory was amended in 2004, three years after the transfer.

Evidence and continuity details

• Transfer 11 took place on 3 March 2001.

• Eleven boxes were listed, but only ten were received.

• The missing box was labelled 'Lantern Operations — Original'.

• The Blue Ledger appears on a duplicate index card as item 11-B.

Episode outcome: The missing box was not lost during the storm; it disappeared during the 2001 records transfer.

Episode 8: The Signalman

Story date: 24 May 2026

Pavel Neri gives Ivo his railway notebook. It records that the 8:55 p.m. train was held outside Blackwood on 14 October 1998 because the signalman received a landslide warning. The train was released at 10:26 p.m. after a handwritten instruction arrived from the municipal emergency committee.

Key scenes

• Pavel says the warning came through a railway telephone, not the public radio system.

• The handwritten release instruction is signed with the initials T.V.

• On the reverse of the note is a short phrase: 'Keep the north line open until the clinic confirms.'

• Lian confirms that no public all-clear was broadcast that night.

Evidence and continuity details

• The 8:55 p.m. train was held outside Blackwood.

• It was released at 10:26 p.m.

• The release instruction carried the initials T.V.

• The note refers to keeping the north line open until Cedar Clinic confirmed.

Episode outcome: The railway record shows that officials were coordinating transport after the storm, even while the public report described a complete communications failure.

Episode 9: Elias's Last Route

Story date: 27 May 2026

Mara follows the footpath from gate 06 to the North Ridge Tunnel. A metal case is hidden behind the old water tank at the eastern entrance. Inside are a maintenance badge, a microcassette and a letter addressed to Mara's mother. The letter says Elias intended to leave Blackwood on 18 October 1998, but first wanted to deliver the Blue Ledger to an independent investigator.

Key scenes

• The maintenance badge identifies Elias as Relay House technician number 04.

• The microcassette contains a short message recorded on 17 October 1998 at 06:40 a.m.

• In the message, Elias says the Blue Ledger was moved from the archive vault to a safe location after the storm.

• The letter does not name the investigator or state where the ledger was hidden.

Evidence and continuity details

• Elias's technician number was 04.

• The microcassette was recorded on 17 October 1998 at 06:40 a.m.

• Elias planned to leave Blackwood on 18 October 1998.

• The location of the Blue Ledger remains undisclosed in the letter.

Episode outcome: Mara learns that her grandfather did not simply disappear; he was trying to preserve evidence.

Episode 10: The Last Signal

Story date: 31 May 2026

Nadia Vale agrees to open the emergency committee's sealed cabinet. The cabinet contains a signed memorandum dated 13 October 1998. It authorizes a controlled evacuation drill on the eastern slope, but a handwritten amendment postpones the public warning until the committee could verify the route. The amendment is initialled T.V. and countersigned J.R. The season ends when Mara's recorder receives a fresh four-note marker from an unknown transmitter.

Key scenes

• Nadia says her father, Tomas Vale, asked the committee to delay the warning because he feared panic before the eastern route was checked.

• Jonas admits that he countersigned the amendment, but says he believed the route would be cleared within minutes.

• Mara compares the memorandum with the clinic log and concludes that the warning reached volunteers before it reached the public.

• Ivo publishes the records, but the Blue Ledger itself is still missing.

Evidence and continuity details

• The memorandum is dated 13 October 1998.

- The amendment is initialled T.V. and countersigned J.R.
- T.V. refers to Tomas Vale and J.R. refers to Jonas Rook, as confirmed in the episode.
- The Blue Ledger is not recovered during season one.
- The final transmission repeats Lantern Code 4: G, C, E, D.

Episode outcome: The town's official story is publicly challenged. The identity of the person sending the new signal is left unresolved for season two.

Consolidated timeline

Date	Event
1996	Project Lantern is created as an emergency-warning network. A training tape establishes Lantern Code 4.
12 October 1998	Room 214 at the Glass Hotel is reserved under the name E. Vale.
13 October 1998	A memorandum authorizes a controlled evacuation drill. An amendment delays the public warning.
14 October 1998, 8:42 p.m.	Lian Chen receives Lantern Code 4 and a message to prepare Cedar Clinic for twelve additional patients.
14 October 1998, 9:05 p.m.	The official report says Station Blackout begins.
14 October 1998, 9:11 p.m.	The emergency beacon at maintenance gate 06 is activated.
14 October 1998, 9:17 p.m.	Morrow Square clock tower stops during the storm.
14 October 1998, 9:30–10:10 p.m.	Cedar Clinic records twelve patients from the eastern slope.
14 October 1998, 10:26 p.m.	The 8:55 p.m. train is released after a note signed T.V.
17 October 1998, 6:40 a.m.	Elias Venn records the microcassette found in the metal case.
18 October 1998	Elias plans to leave Blackwood.
3 March 2001	Transfer 11 lists eleven Relay House boxes; only ten are delivered.
2004	The municipal archive basement inventory is amended.
4 May 2026	Mara discovers the cassette that starts the investigation.
31 May 2026	The emergency committee memorandum is made public.

Mystery facts and unresolved questions

The following distinctions matter when answering questions about the series:

• The Blue Ledger is missing at the end of season one. The guide does not reveal its final hiding place.

• The guide does not identify the anonymous sender of the envelope in episode one.

• The guide does not identify the unknown woman at the Room 214 meeting.

• The initials E.V. in the Cedar Clinic log are not conclusively identified as Elias Venn.

• The person or organization transmitting the final signal at the end of episode ten is unknown.

• The official report says the Station Blackout began at 9:05 p.m.; this is not the same as the clock tower stopping at 9:17 p.m.

• The clinic log records twelve patients, while the official town report lists seven storm injuries. Do not assume that the five-person difference is fully explained by the guide.

RAG evaluation questions

Use these questions to test your chatbot after ingestion. The answers should be grounded in this guide, and the chatbot should mention episode numbers or timeline dates where possible.

1. What are the four notes in Lantern Code 4, and who identifies them?

2. How many patients did Cedar Clinic receive from the eastern slope, and during what time window?

3. What is the difference between the official Station Blackout time and the time the Morrow Square clock tower stopped?

4. Who reserved Room 214, on what date, and what special request did the guest make?

5. What was missing from Transfer 11, and how many boxes were actually delivered?

6. Which evidence connects the eastern route to Cedar Clinic?

7. What did the railway notebook say about the 8:55 p.m. train?

8. When did Elias record the microcassette, and when did he plan to leave Blackwood?

9. Who initialled and countersigned the 13 October memorandum amendment?

10. Where is the Blue Ledger hidden?

11. Who sent the final signal at the end of season one?

12. What was the name of the unknown woman who attended the Glass Hotel meeting?

Questions 10–12 are deliberate abstention tests: the correct answer is that the guide does not say.